



SHOW OF FORCE: Chinese police stand guard at an army compound in Gansu province as Tibetans look on

neighbours CHINA

AP PHOTO/ANDY WONG

OLYMPIC HURDLE

Tibet raises the banner of protest to embarrass China before this summer's Olympic Games but Beijing handles international pressure deftly while retaining its iron grip over the region

■ **By M. Thomas in Beijing**

After the riots in Tibet, the penny has finally dropped: Beijing knows there is little it can do to prevent the politicisation of this summer's Olympic Games. The roll-call of contentious issues is too long. Apart from Tibet, Taiwanese independence, human rights abuse, the suppression of Falun Gong and Muslim separatism all remain in the queue. An opinion piece in *Global Times*, which has close links with the Communist Party mouthpiece *People's Daily*, concluded that trouble accompanying the Games is unavoidable.

In China's national parliament, Premier Wen Jiabao laid the blame for last week's violent protests in Tibet